THE FAPS CHRONICLES

NOV WEEK 1 • COURAGE IS DESTINY • 9TH NOVEMBER2026

EXPRESSIONS!

The school grounds were filled with pure excitement as students, teachers and the interact club gathered for our annual fest, Expressions.

Right from early morning, the organizing committee, student council, and student volunteers were running around setting up tables, hanging colorful decorations, testing sound systems, and organizing the entry gates.

One of the absolute sweetest parts of the day was seeing the students from lower grades running their own small booths with massive smiles, handling money, talking to customers, and showing off impressive confidence.

The huge variety of stalls was a total hit, offering delicious homemade snacks, cold drinks, craft booths, and little pop-up shops.







Students from several visiting schools streamed through the gates to join in on the fun, while many of our past graduates and alumni returned to campus to cheer everyone on, and serve as judges.

Down on the open field and outdoor courts, the **football and basketball** tournaments drew loud, cheering crowds as players gave it their absolute all.

Over on the main stage, the **Fashion Show** was a huge crowd-puller, where teams walked the runway in creative outfits.

For those who preferred solving puzzles over sports, the students also hosted a **Murder Mystery** event, where participants acted like detectives, piecing together tricky clues, analizing evidence, and racing against the clock to solve the case.

Meanwhile, commerce students got their turn to shine in **Venture wars**, a business competition where young entrepreneurs pitched original startup ideas and answered tough questions from a panel of judges.





It is notable that **The Poverty Football Club (PFC) defeated St Joseph's PUC** 1–0 in a penalty shootout during the finals.

The **Mad Ads** competition had the entire audience laughing out loud, the **Personality** contest tested individual participants on their quick thinking, charm, and composure through a series of funny and challenging Q&A rounds.

Dancers brought incredible high energy to the floor during **Elàn**, performing syncronized routines to upbeat music that had the crowd standing up and cheering after every single song.

In **Market Masters**, teams used ₹10,00,000 in virtual capital to bid on business assets and outsmart competitors.

In **The Last Verdict**, participants stepped back in time to bring major historical legal cases to life. Given a surprise case on the spot, teams acted as opposing counsels to analyze facts, research the law, and defend their case under pressure.

The **Drums n' Roses** was a great event for the student who wanted to showcase their music talent.

By the time the final awards were handed out and the music stopped, the sheer teamwork, dedication, and spirit of the entire school had turned this year's festival into an unforgettable success.

Butterfly

~By Sreemayi Pradeep (9 'A')

Butterfly I am a butterfly with beautiful wings that enhance the colors
of my love for the world.
I am a butterfly: from being a cocoon. I saw my wings being unfurled.
I fly freely. Worrying about nobody.
I fly everywhere. from cities to forests.
But my home. the orange tree. looked the brightest.

I fly around the park. and my wings flutter.
I see a girl. and I sit on her arm: she sees me.
And smiles in glee. But one move and I fly and disappear.

Old women sit alone. desolate and pessimistic.
I must say. They don't deserve it. as it is a beautiful day.
I sit on the edge of the bench. sitting next to them.
Just so they know that I fly with them.

I have no one at the end of the day.
But the smiles on people's faces are what I need.
I will stay with people if they need me to be there all day.
I will dance and fly because I am. for once. freed.

I am a butterfly. and this is my story.
Nothing much to see. but I am happy.
I have no pride or glory. As I am merely a butterfly.
With a tiny little heart filled with a lot of love.

WEIRD BUT TRUE!

On Saturn and Jupiter, it literally rains diamonds. Extreme atmospheric pressure crushes carbon gas into solid chunks of diamond, which fall through the sky like hailstones into the deep ocean cores.





Trees can actually communicate and protect each other. Using a vast underground network of fungus roots, they share essential nutrients and warn neighboring trees about incoming insect attacks or severe droughts.

The mighty Napoleon Bonaparte was once defeated by bunnies. In 1807, when thousands of tame rabbits were released for a hunt, they mistook Napoleon for their feeder and aggressively swarmed his legs, forcing the fierce emperor to flee in his carriage.





The shortest war in human history lasted just 38 minutes. In 1896, the British Empire clashed with the island of Zanzibar. Before the clock could even hit an hour, Zanzibar surrendered, ending the conflict in record time.

A blue whale's heart is as big as a car. It weighs nearly 180 kilograms, and its massive heartbeat is so incredibly loud that scientists can **easily detect it from two kilometres away.**



THAT'S CONCERNING...

IS SLEEP REALLY *THAT* IMPORTANT?

There is a toxic badge of honor floating around Indian schools and coaching centers: the idea that sleeping four hours makes you a warrior, and surviving on sheer caffeine and panic is proof of your ambition.

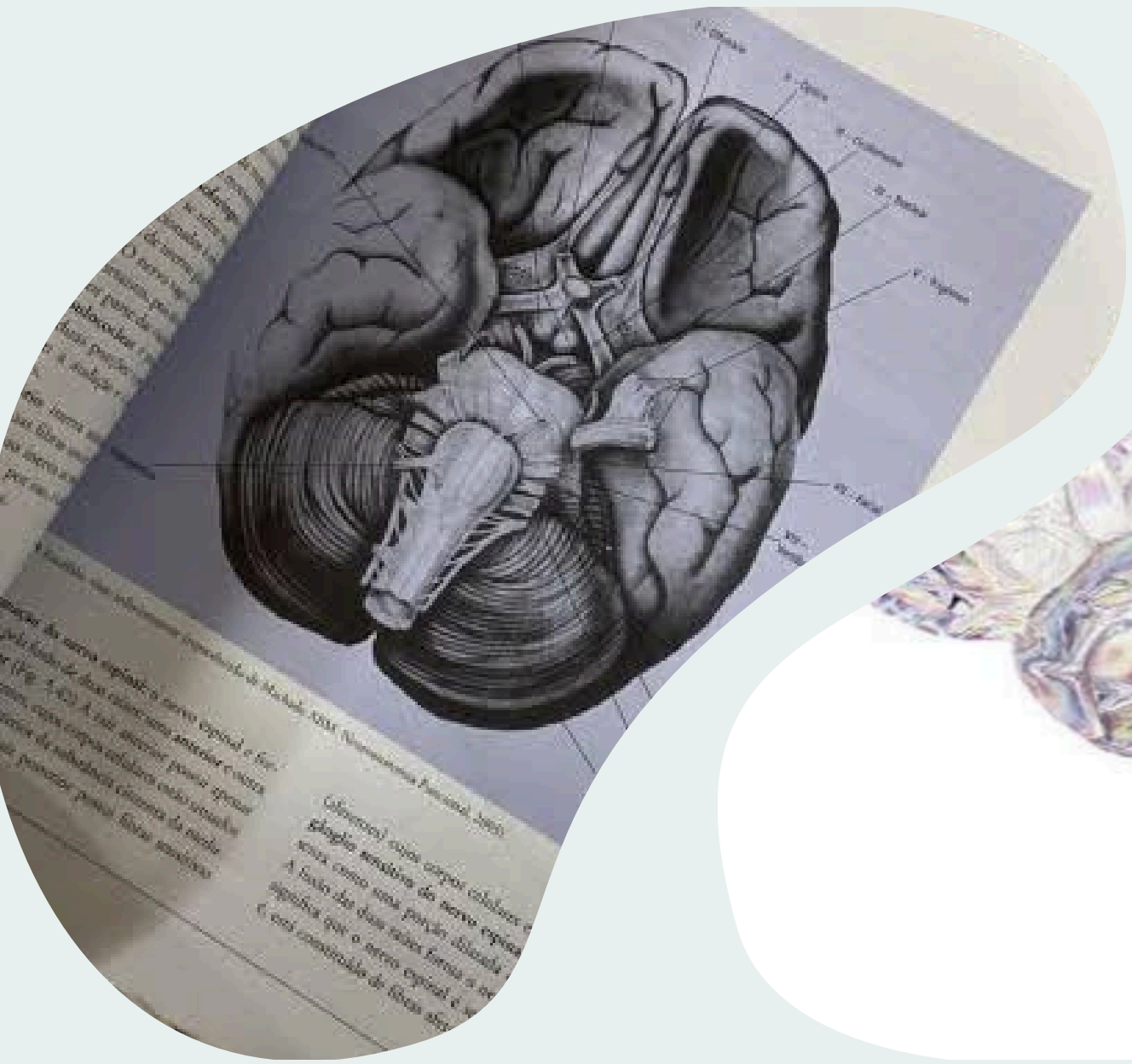
It's actually a scam you're running on yourself.

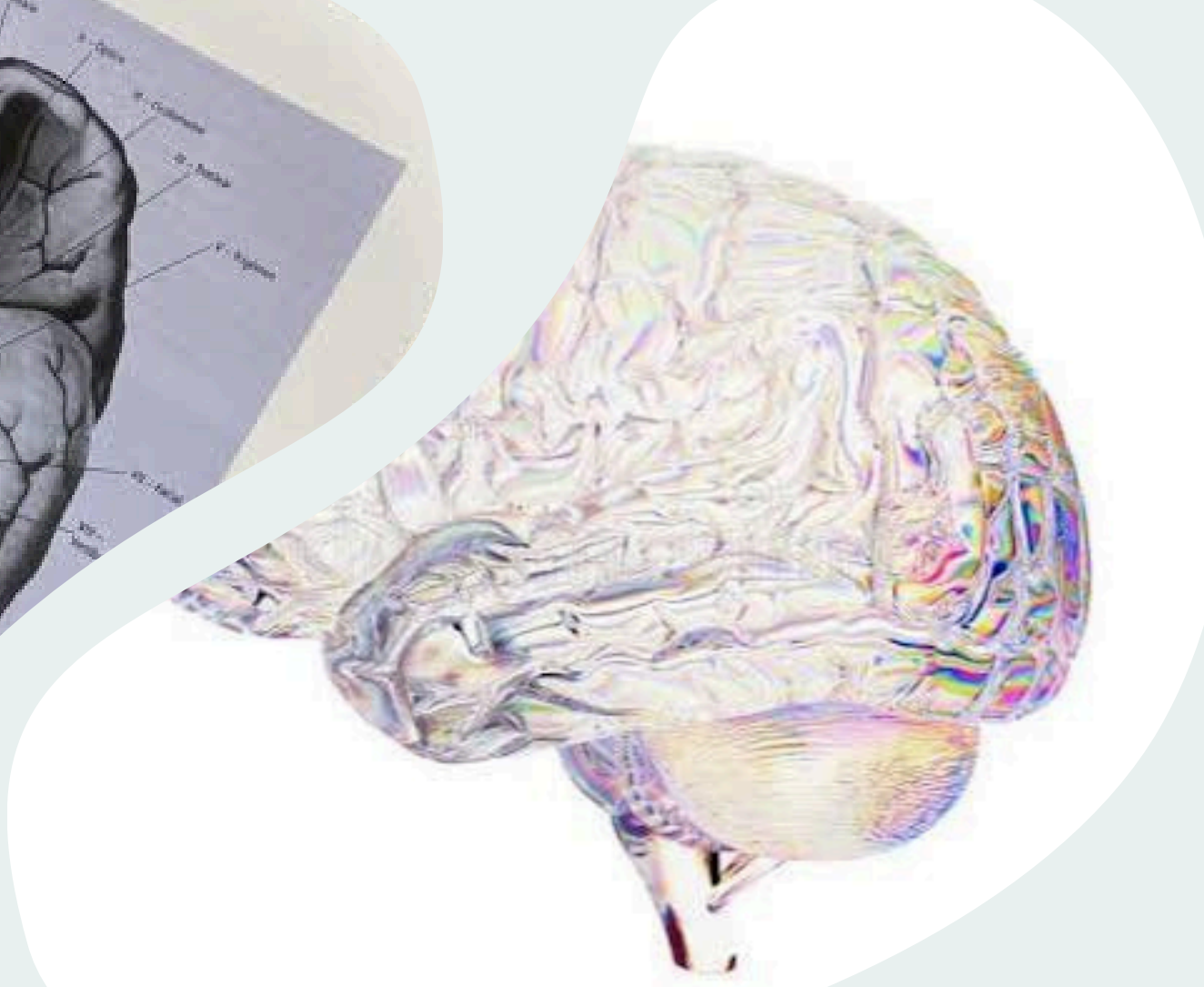
When you stay up until 2:00 AM cramming physics derivations or accountancy formats, you aren't outworking your competition—you are literally sabotaging your own hardware.





Neuroscience shows that the brain does not permanently store what you study while you're studying it. That transfer happens exclusively during slow-wave and REM sleep, where your hippocampus replays and cements new concepts into long-term memory. Skimping on sleep to study more is like typing a brilliant 2,000-word essay and repeatedly slamming the laptop shut without hitting "Save."





Meanwhile, your brain's glymphatic system—essentially the biological night-shift cleaning crew—only activates while you are in deep slumber to flush out neurotoxic metabolic waste. Skip that cycle, and your prefrontal cortex operates the next day in a state equivalent to being legally intoxicated. Your reaction speed drops, your focus dissolves, and those silly mistakes on test papers that make you kick yourself? That isn't bad luck. That's a starved, unwashed brain misfiring under pressure.

STUDENTS AWAIT GTA 6...

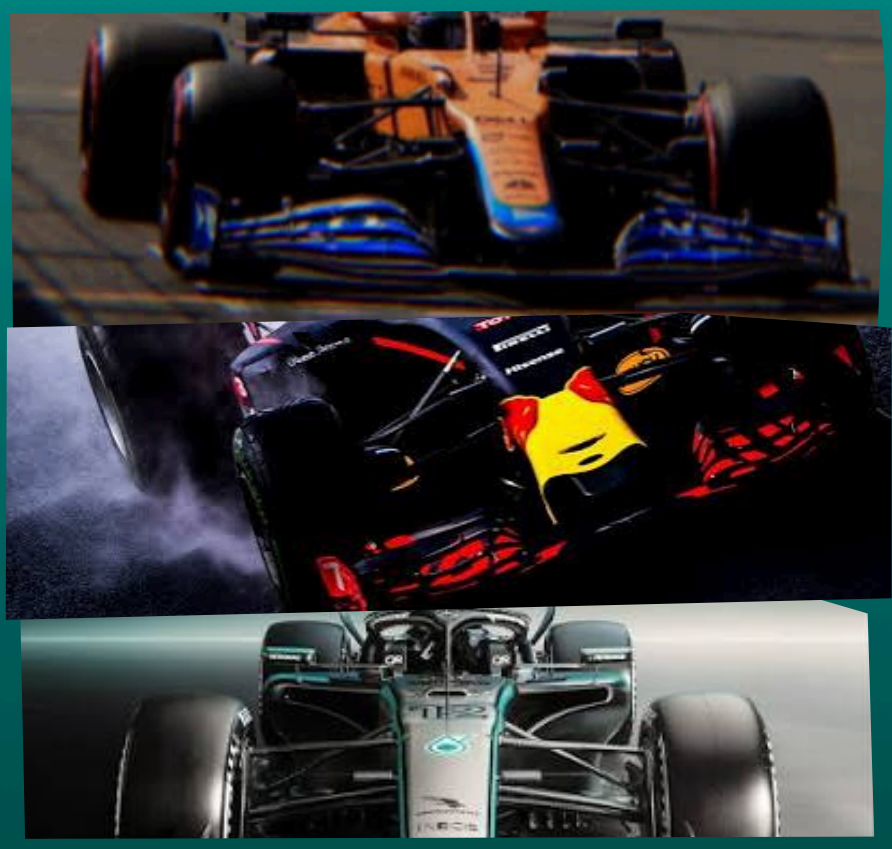
GLOBAL SPORTS

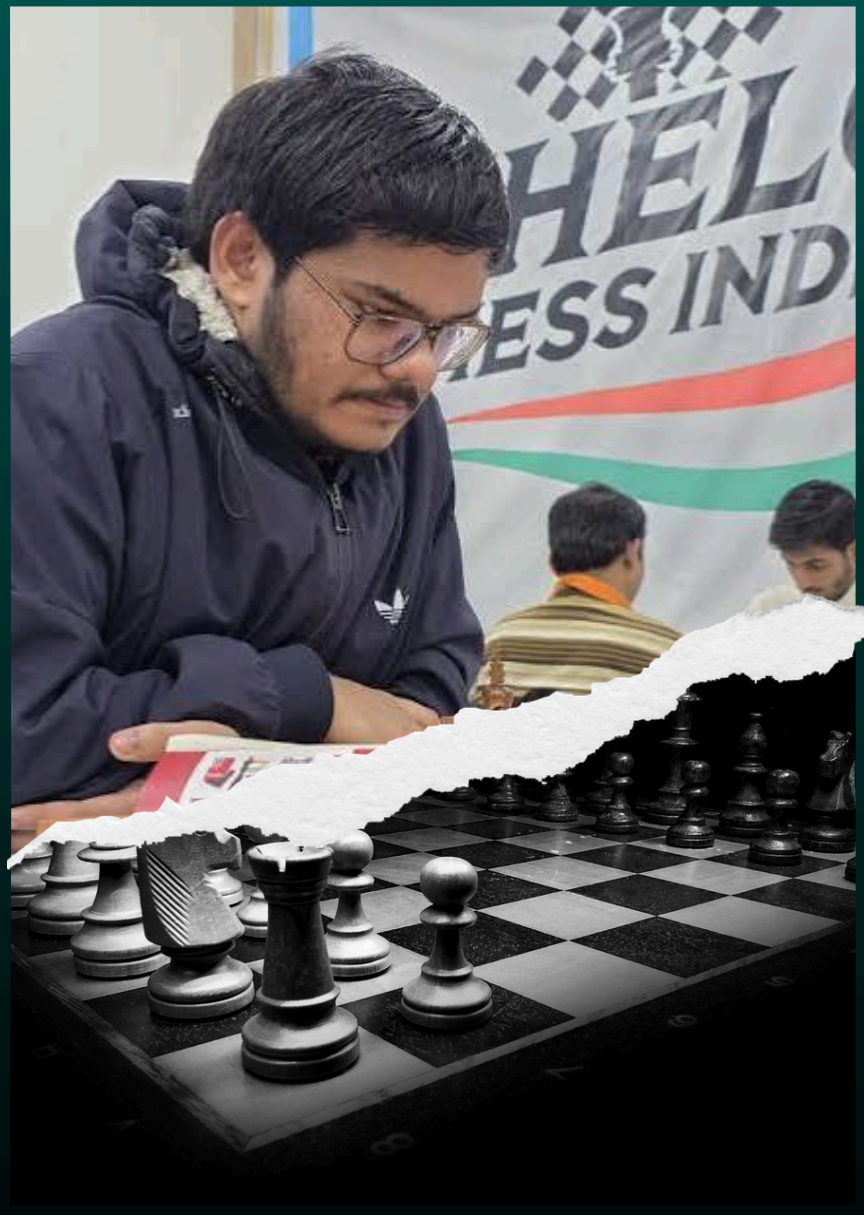
NORRIS WINS, MERCEDES CLINCHES F1 TITLE

McLaren's Lando Norris mastered a rain-soaked track to win the São Paulo Grand Prix from pole position.

Behind him, Max Verstappen staged an incredible comeback from 21st to finish second.

However, Mercedes stole the show, securing the 2026 Constructors' Championship to collect their ninth historic team title after a thrilling weekend.





SHRIVATRI MAKES HISTORY AS INDIA'S 100TH CHESS GRANDMASTER

Madhya Pradesh's **Anuj Shrivatri** won the 7th ASEAN Plus Individual Open Chess Championship in the Philippines to secure the direct Grandmaster title. Despite losing his very first game, the 22-year-old staged a phenomenal comeback. He scored seven points across nine rounds to finish ahead of the field. Shrivatri's triumph marks a historic milestone as India's 100th Grandmaster. He also becomes the first-ever Grandmaster to emerge from Madhya Pradesh.

CURRENT SCIENCE



ISRO ACES SATELLITE LAUNCH

India's space agency, ISRO, is preparing to launch its next-generation navigation satellite, NVS-03, aboard the powerful GSLV-F18 rocket. **This mission represents a massive upgrade for the country's indigenous NavIC constellation, which provides precision positioning across the region.** Positioned in a geosynchronous orbit, the advanced satellite carries a highly accurate atomic clock to ensure seamless tracking and timing data. By expanding coverage and enhancing signal reliability for civilian and strategic users alike, this launch **marks a crucial step forward in India's quest for technological independence,** sharpening its eyes in the sky and securing its place among elite spacefaring nations.

MEET THE SUPER MAGNET

Scientists recently confirmed a brand-new, third type of magnetism called **altermagnetism**.

Until now, we mostly knew about regular magnets that stick to fridges (ferromagnets) and hidden magnets that cancel themselves out (antiferromagnets).

Altermagnets are a special hybrid of both. On the outside, they have no magnetic pull, meaning they won't stick to your fridge. But on the inside, they possess a unique, twisted structure that allows electricity to flow through them at lightning speeds.

This discovery will help engineers build ultra-fast computers and smartphones that **never overheat**, making electronics much more powerful and energy-efficient for the future.



STUDENTS' VOICE

WHAT'S THE GENERAL OPINION ABOUT THE SCHOOL'S SCIENCE LABS?

SCHOOL LABS, I WOULD NOT SAY THEY'RE WELL MAINTAINED, BUT THEY'RE DECENT. AT LEAST IN OUR SCHOOL THEY TRY THEIR BEST TO KEEP IT UP TO BASIC STANDARDS; IT'S NOT THAT GOOD, BUT IT'S THERE.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN TO THE LABS VERY OFTEN?

IT'S BECAUSE OF THE PEOPLE IN FAPS. OUR SCHOOL IS VERY LENIENT, AND THERE ARE CERTAIN PEOPLE FROM CLASSES WHO WILL END UP MESSING UP THINGS IN THE LAB OR BREAKING SOMETHING. THAT'S WHY.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS COULD BECOME BETTER?

THEY CAN BE UPGRADED BY ADDING NEW EQUIPMENT TO THEM. IT'S MOSTLY USED BY 11TH AND 12TH GRADERS SO IT MATCHES THAT STANDARD, BUT IN OUR WHOLE SCHOOL LIFE, I'VE ONLY BEEN TAKEN ONCE IN 10TH GRADE.

-ANGAD SINGH (CLASS 11 SCIENCE)

THE SCHOOL LABS ARE LOWKEY BAD, HONESTLY, BECAUSE THEY NEVER TAKE US! THERE'S NO POINT TO THEM IF THEY NEVER TAKE US.

WHY DO YOU THINK THEY NEVER TAKE US?

THEY PROBABLY DON'T TRUST US. KNOWING FAPS KIDS, THEY'RE **GOING TO BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN!** THE CHEM LAB LOOKS LIKE IT COULD BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN TOO.

WHAT ABOUT THE OTHER LABS, LIKE THE BIOLOGY AND PHYSICS LABS?

THE BIO LAB IS GOATED BECAUSE OF SREEJA MA'AM, BUT THE PHYSICS LAB IS JUST THERE BECAUSE ARUN KUMAR SIR JUST SITS THERE.

WOULD TAKING STUDENTS TO LABS IN LOWER GRADES HELP THEM CHOOSE SCIENCE AS THEIR STREAM?

PROBABLY NOT, BECAUSE THEY ARE NOT GOING TO UNDERSTAND BASIC EXPERIMENTS. KIDS WILL **JUST MIX RANDOM THINGS** LIKE HYDROCHLORIC ACID AND OTHER ACIDS, MAKE RANDOM ANSWERS, AND BURN THE SCHOOL DOWN!

-MATHIEU VANBUERLE (CLASS 9C)

EVERY TIME I ENTER THE PHYSICS LAB THERE'S LIKE **NOTHING ON THE TABLE**—IT LOOKS **LIKE A DINING TABLE!** (REFERS TO SOMEONE) **IS LITERALLY HAVING A NICE MEAL EVERY TIME I WALK IN THERE**. WHAT THE HELL IS HAPPENING, DUDE? IT'S A PHYSICS LAB, NOT A DINING LAB!

DO YOU THINK WE SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LABS MORE OFTEN?

DEFINITELY! WE GET TO SEE MORE PRACTICALITY INSTEAD OF JUST READING THEORY AND TRYING TO IMAGINE THAT IN OUR HEAD. WE LOWKEY **NEED TO SEE IT IN PERSON**, IN PERSPECTIVE—JUST WITHOUT MY FRIEND EATING THERE.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?

THE PHYSICS LAB NEEDS MORE APPARATUSES. FOR THE CHEMISTRY LAB, WE NEED TO BE TAKEN THERE MORE SO STUDENTS CAN PERFORM EXPERIMENTS AND SEE THE PRACTICALITY OF IT, INSTEAD OF JUST MEMORISING COLOURS AND IDENTITY TESTS.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN THAT OFTEN?

BECAUSE WE HAVE PEOPLE LIKE MY (REFERING TO THE SAME PERSON) WHO WILL **JUST STRAIGHT UP DRINK ALL THE CHEMICALS**!

-JAIRUS REMIGUS MOTHA (CLASS 10C)

THE LABS ARE ACTUALLY QUITE GOOD, BUT THE ONLY THING IS WE'RE NOT ALLOWED TO GO THERE VERY MUCH—ONLY 11TH AND 12TH GRADERS ARE ALLOWED. CONSIDERING THAT IN OTHER SCHOOLS YOU CAN GO TO THE LABS EVEN FROM 9TH GRADE, IT ISN'T A VERY GOOD FEATURE TO HAVE THEM AND THEN NOT USE THEM.

DO YOU THINK STUDENTS SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LAB IN 7TH AND 8TH GRADE TO HELP THEM CHOOSE THEIR STREAM?

NO, NOT REALLY. IN 7TH AND 8TH, PHYSICS IS JUST HEATING SOLIDS, LIQUIDS, AND GASES, AND CHEMISTRY IS BASIC EQUATIONS. AND WHAT DO YOU EVEN DO IN THE BIO LAB? SHOW THEM A SNAKE? EVEN US 9TH AND 10TH GRADERS, ALL WE DO IN THE BIO LAB IS **JUST NAME THE SKELETON "DINESH"—THAT'S ABOUT IT!**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?

MAINLY BECAUSE OF CHEMICALS! MOST OF US JOKE ABOUT BOMBS WITHOUT KNOWING THE DESTRUCTION OF THEM, SO THE MOMENT WE STEP FOOT INTO THE LAB, IT **WOULDN'T TAKE MUCH FOR SOMEONE TO MIX A FEW CHEMICALS TOGETHER AND JUST BOOM**. THE CHEMISTRY TEACHERS DEFINITELY CANNOT HANDLE US.

-SAMARTH SHENOY (CLASS 10B)

ALL OF THEM ARE GOOD—THEY ARE ALL **NICE AND MAINTAINED,** BUT I WISH WE COULD USE THEM MORE OFTEN. I WISH THEY WERE MORE INVOLVED IN OUR DAY-TO-DAY ACTIVITIES AND WE WERE TAKEN TO THE LABS A **BIT MORE FOR LEARNING.**

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN VERY OFTEN?

BECAUSE THE ICSE SYLLABUS DOESN'T REQUIRE THAT MUCH LAB WORK, AND **DEMONSTRATIONS ARE USUALLY SHOWN ON SMART TVS IN EACH CLASS**. STILL, PHYSICAL LAB WORK WHERE WE DO REACTIONS **UNDER SUPERVISION WOULD HELP US UNDERSTAND TOPICS A LOT MORE.**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?

THERE ARE SO MANY CHEMICALS THERE AND YOU KNOW HOW NOTORIOUS SOME PEOPLE CAN BE. SO JUST TAKE THE SMART PEOPLE! AM I REFERRING TO MYSELF? MAYBE! BUT I SAY JUST TAKE THE SMART PEOPLE. IF THERE ARE ANY DAMAGES, WE PAY FOR IT; THAT'S THE ONLY VALID WAY TO DO IT.

WOULD BEING TAKEN TO THE LAB IN 7TH OR 8TH GRADE HELP STUDENTS CHOOSE THEIR STREAM?

YES, DEFINITELY. WHEN YOU PRACTICALLY DO STUFF IN A LAB, YOU ACTUALLY FEEL WHETHER **YOU'RE KEEN ON DOING SCIENCE OR NOT.**

-ISHAAN BOHRA (CLASS 10A)

I THINK THE SCIENCE LAB IS VERY NICE, THE EQUIPMENT ARE WELL ORGANIZED, AND **THEY ARE WELL MAINTAINED**. BUT I FEEL LIKE THERE SHOULD BE MORE SCIENCE LAB CLASSES BECAUSE THEY ARE NOT WELL UTILIZED—WE SHOULD GO AT LEAST TWO TIMES A WEEK.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?

MAYBE WE CAN ADD MORE **AI AND MAKE IT AI-POWERED**! MAYBE ADD A TV IN THE LAB ALSO... WAIT, THERE IS A TV IN THE LAB? MY BAD! I MEAN, YEAH, THAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU'RE NOT TAKEN TO THE LAB OFTEN!

WHAT DO YOU THINK ABOUT THE MYSTERY OF THE CHEM LAB AND WHY AREN'T WE TAKEN THERE?

I THINK THE CHEMISTRY LAB IS WAY TOO DANGEROUS FOR 8TH AND 9TH GRADERS, AND T**HERE ARE MANY NAUGHTY CHILDREN WHO MIGHT TOUCH THE WRONG CHEMICALS**! BUT TAKING STUDENTS IN BATCHES UNDER THE CHEMISTRY TEACHER'S SUPERVISION WOULD WORK.

-NEERAJ K (CLASS 10A)

THE CHEM LAB IS THE MOST INTERESTING LAB IN THE SCHOOL, BUT WE HARDLY EVER SEE IT. IT'S **FULL OF EQUIPMENT AND EXPERIMENTS** THAT WE ONLY READ ABOUT IN TEXTBOOKS, AND **THAT FEELS LIKE A WASTE.**

WHY ARE WE NEVER TAKEN TO THE CHEM LAB?
BECAUSE OF THE CHEMICALS. EVERYONE KNOWS HOW RISKY IT CAN BE IF A CLASS GOES IN WITHOUT PROPER SUPERVISION, AND **ONE WRONG MIX CAN TURN INTO A BIG PROBLEM**. I UNDERSTAND WHY TEACHERS ARE CAREFUL, BUT NOT GOING AT ALL ISN'T THE ANSWER EITHER.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BECOME BETTER?
THE CHEM LAB NEEDS A **DEDICATED IN-CHARGE**, SOMEONE WHOSE JOB IS TO LOOK AFTER IT, **KEEP TRACK OF THE CHEMICALS AND EQUIPMENT, AND SUPERVISE STUDENTS DURING EXPERIMENTS**. THAT WAY TEACHERS WOULDN'T HAVE TO WORRY ABOUT SAFETY, AND MORE CLASSES COULD ACTUALLY GO.

DO YOU THINK WE SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LABS MORE OFTEN?
YES. WE SHOULD HAVE A LAB CLASS AFTER EVERY 5 REGULAR CLASSES. THAT'S REGULAR ENOUGH THAT WE'D GET REAL PRACTICE, AND IT STILL LEAVES PLENTY OF TIME FOR THEORY. **SEEING A REACTION HAPPEN IS SO MUCH BETTER THAN MEMORIZING IT.**

-KARAN (CLASS 10B

TEACHER'S THOUGHTS

I FEEL THAT **LABORATORIES ARE EXTREMELY IMPORTANT**, AND THE EXPOSURE YOU GET IN A LAB IS INVALUABLE. PERSONALLY, THROUGHOUT MY LIFE, **I HAVE LOVED LABS MORE THAN THEORY CLASSES** BECAUSE YOU GET TO EXPLORE SO MANY THINGS. AS YOU GROW OLDER, ESPECIALLY IF YOU PURSUE SCIENCE, YOU WILL FIND YOURSELF IN THE LABORATORY MORE THAN IN THE CLASSROOM. YOU WILL BE EXPLORING THINGS ON YOUR OWN, WITHOUT TEACHERS TELLING YOU WHAT TO DO, AND THAT BECOMES FUN — IT BECOMES SECOND NATURE.

WHY DO YOU THINK WE AREN'T TAKEN TO THE LABS VERY OFTEN?
I THINK IT IS BECAUSE OF OUR NUMBERS. THERE ARE A LOT OF YOU! ALSO, IT HAS TO DO WITH THE WAY OUR TIMETABLES ARE STRUCTURED. UNTIL 10TH GRADE, EVEN WHEN I WAS IN SCHOOL, **WE WERE TAKEN TO THE LAB ONLY ONCE OR TWICE A YEAR.** MANY TEACHERS, INCLUDING ME, BRING EXPERIMENTS TO THE CLASSROOM TO DEMONSTRATE THEM — REMEMBER THE EXPERIMENTS I BROUGHT TO CLASS? IT IS EASIER TO BRING THE EXPERIMENTS TO YOU FOR VARIOUS REASONS - SPACE, SAFETY, ETC. WHEN YOU GO TO **HIGHER CLASSES, YOU HAVE LABS WITH LARGER CAPACITIES** TO CATER TO LARGE NUMBER OF STUDENTS.

WOULD IT BE BENEFICIAL IF 7TH OR 8TH GRADERS WERE TAKEN TO THE LAB TO HELP WITH STREAM SELECTION?
I AM NOT SURE IF TAKING THEM TO THE LAB WOULD HELP, BECAUSE MANY OF US WHO TEACH 7TH AND 8TH GRADERS BRING THE EXPERIMENTS DIRECTLY TO THE CLASSROOM. NINTH AND 10TH GRADERS ARE A LITTLE MORE DISCIPLINED, BUT **7TH AND 8TH GRADERS DO NOT ALWAYS TAKE IT THAT SERIOUSLY** — FOR THEM, IT IS MOSTLY JUST FUN. WHILE A HANDFUL WILL BE INTERESTED, **MANY MORE WILL HAVE MISCHIEF ON THEIR MINDS** AND WILL WANT TO EXPLORE OTHER THINGS RATHER THAN CONCENTRATE ON WHAT THE TEACHER IS SAYING. CONCENTRATION IS BETTER IN A FAMILIAR CLASSROOM. WHEN SOMETHING IS NOT FEASIBLE TO DEMONSTRATE IN CLASS — LIKE AN EXPERIMENT INVOLVING FIRE OR A FLAME WHEN I TEACH CHEMISTRY — **WE SHOW SIMULATIONS ON THE SMARTBOARD**. THEY HAVE AMAZING REACTIONS, SO STUDENTS ARE LEARNING IN A HANDS-ON MANNER EITHER WAY.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BE MADE BETTER?
THERE IS ALWAYS SCOPE FOR IMPROVEMENT. AS NEW TECHNOLOGIES EMERGE, WE CAN UPGRADE OUR EQUIPMENT — FOR EXAMPLE, BY **GETTING MICROSCOPES WITH HIGHER RESOLUTION OR CREATING MORE WORKSPACE TO ACCOMMODATE MORE PEOPLE**. BUT BASED ON WHAT I HAVE SEEN OF OUR FACILITIES, I THINK WE ARE **BLESSED TO HAVE SUCH FABULOUS FACILITIES**. IN MANY OTHER SCHOOLS, LABS ARE OFTEN VERY SMALL. AT FAPS, BOTH THE LIBRARY AND THE LABS ARE TRULY FABULOUS.

WHAT DO YOU THINK ABOUT THE VARIETY OF SPECIMENS IN THE BIOLOGY LAB, AND WHAT IS YOUR FAVOURITE SPECIMEN?
THEY ARE MORE THAN ADEQUATE. SINCE WE CATER TO STUDENTS FROM 11TH AND 12TH GRADES, AND THERE IS AN **OVERLAP WITH THE CLASSIFICATION OF KINGDOMS TAUGHT FROM 7TH GRADE** ONWARDS, WE HAVE VIRTUALLY EVERY SPECIMEN. IT IS ONE OF THE BEST-EQUIPPED LABS IN BANGALORE. AS FOR **MY FAVOURITE SPECIMEN, I THINK IT WOULD BE THE FETEUS** — IT IS ANATOMICALLY VERY ACCURATE AND QUITE FASCINATING. **THE SKELETON IS FINE TOO!**

— MRS. MANISHA

MY BIOLOGY LAB IS LIKE MY HOME. CHILDREN LOVE COMING TO THE LAB AND EXPLORING THE THINGS KEPT THERE. ESPECIALLY THE LITTLE ONES THEY **COME TO SEE THE BABY IN THE BOTTLE**. MY 11TH AND 12TH STANDARD CLASSES ARE ALSO CONDUCTED IN THE BIO LAB NOW THAT **WE HAVE A SMART TV ALL THANKS TO OUR SCHOOL MANAGEMENT** FOR THAT.

SHOULD YOUNGER GRADES LIKE 7-8 BE BROUGHT TO THE LABS AS IT COULD HELP IN CHOOSING THEIR STREAMS?
CLASS 6-7 AND 8 ARE ALL BROUGHT TO THE LAB ONCE A YEAR TO SHOW THE SPECIMEN. IT'S NOT POSSIBLE TO BRING THEM ESPECIALLY TO THE LAB DUE TO THE TIME LIMIT AS THE **TEACHERS HAVE TO FINISH THE PORTIONS AND THE NUMBER OF PERIODS ARE LESS**.

HOW DO YOU THINK THE LABS CAN BE MADE BETTER?
THE LABS ARE GOOD AND A SCHOOL PROVIDED US WHATEVER WE NEEDED FOR THE LAB BUT IT **CAN REMAIN GOOD ONLY IF THE CHILDREN DON'T SPOIL IT**. ONCE THEY COME TO THE LAB, THEY ARE SO EXCITED THAT **THEY START MEDDLING** WITH THINGS KEPT IN THE LAB.

DO YOU THINK EXPLORING THE LAB CAN HELP THE STUDENTS UNDERSTAND THE CONCEPT BETTER?
EXPLORING THE LAB AND THE EXPERIMENTS HELP A CHILD TO UNDERSTAND WHETHER HE OR SHE CAN HAS AN APTITUDE FOR THE SUBJECT OR NOT, AT LEAST 50% BECAUSE THE OTHER 50% COME FROM THEORY.

– MRS SREEJA MOHAN (BIOLOGY TEACHER)

CHEMISTRY LABORATORIES ARE FASCINATING YET INHERENTLY DANGEROUS ENVIRONMENTS, WHICH IS WHY STUDENTS ARE TYPICALLY RESTRICTED FROM ENTERING THEM. WHILE WEARING MANDATORY PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT ENSURES SAFETY, I FIRMLY BELIEVE **8TH GRADE ONWARDS SHOULD BE ALLOWED UNDER STRICT PRECAUTIONS.**

WHY DO YOU THINK WE ARE NOT TAKEN TO THE LAB FREQUENTLY?
TO MANAGE SAFETY CONCERNS, STUDENTS CAN BE **BROUGHT INTO THE LAB IN SMALLER BATCHES**, ALLOWING TEACHERS TO ACTIVELY ADDRESS AND SOLVE ANY ISSUES THAT ARISE. LEAVING A CHEMISTRY LAB EMPTY MAKES LITTLE SENSE WHEN IT IS A ROOM PURPOSE-BUILT FOR EDUCATION; STUDENTS NEED TO INTERACT WITH THE CHEMICALS TO TRULY LEARN. WE CAN SPARK THEIR INTEREST BY STARTING WITH VIBRANT, COLORFUL EXPERIMENTS BEFORE GRADUALLY INTRODUCING MORE CHALLENGING ONES.

DO YOU THINK EXPERIMENT CONDUCTION HELPS IN UNDERSTANDING CONCEPTS BETTER?
VISITING THE LAB CONVERTS ABSTRACT TEXTBOOK THEORIES INTO **REAL, EXPERIENTIAL SCIENCE**. BECAUSE CHEMISTRY ULTIMATELY BEGINS IN THE KITCHEN, STUDENTS FROM 8TH GRADE ONWARDS ARE FULLY CAPABLE OF UNDERSTANDING THESE PRACTICAL CONCEPTS.

DO YOU THINK THE LABS HELP STUDENTS CHOOSE THEIR STREAMS?
ULTIMATELY, EARLY LAB EXPOSURE **GIVES STUDENTS A GENUINE TASTE OF THE SUBJECT**, HELPING THEM MAKE INFORMED CHOICES ABOUT THEIR FUTURE ACADEMIC STREAMS.

– MRS. PALLAVI MG (CHEMISTRY TEACHER)

"I STRONGLY BELIEVE THAT A LABORATORY IS NOT MERELY A ROOM FILLED WITH CHEMICALS AND APPARATUS; IT IS A PLACE WHERE SCIENTIFIC CURIOSITY COMES ALIVE. STUDENTS SHOULD BE ENCOURAGED TO OBSERVE, QUESTION, EXPERIMENT AND LEARN THROUGH PRACTICAL EXPERIENCES. WHILE THEORETICAL KNOWLEDGE BUILDS THE FOUNDATION, PRACTICAL EXPOSURE HELPS STUDENTS CONNECT CONCEPTS WITH REAL-LIFE APPLICATIONS.

OUR AIM SHOULD BE TO CREATE AN ENVIRONMENT WHERE STUDENTS DEVELOP SCIENTIFIC THINKING, CONFIDENCE AND A GENUINE LOVE FOR LEARNING, WHILE NEVER COMPROMISING ON SAFETY.

OUR SCIENCE LABORATORIES ARE SPACIOUS AND WELL-EQUIPPED, WITH THE NECESSARY APPARATUS AND REAGENTS REQUIRED FOR CONDUCTING VARIOUS EXPERIMENTS AND DEMONSTRATING CHEMICAL REACTIONS.

THE BIOLOGY LABORATORY HAS A VERY VIBRANT AND LIVELY ATMOSPHERE, WITH SPECIMENS AND OTHER MATERIALS THAT HELP STUDENTS UNDERSTAND BIOLOGICAL CONCEPTS BETTER.

THE CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS PARTICULARLY INTERESTING BECAUSE IT HOUSES SOME OF THE OLDEST APPARATUS, WHICH GIVES STUDENTS AN OPPORTUNITY TO APPRECIATE THE HISTORY AND EVOLUTION OF SCIENTIFIC EQUIPMENT. WE EVEN HAVE A WEIGHING BALANCE THAT IS APPROXIMATELY 25 YEARS OLD!

EACH LABORATORY HAS ITS OWN IMPORTANCE AND PLAYS A SIGNIFICANT ROLE IN MAKING SCIENCE LEARNING MORE MEANINGFUL AND EXPERIENTIAL.

WHY IS ACCESS TO THE CHEMISTRY LABORATORY MORE RESTRICTED COMPARED TO THE PHYSICS AND BIOLOGY LABORATORIES?

SAFETY IS OUR FOREMOST CONCERN, PARTICULARLY IN A CHEMISTRY LABORATORY.

UNLIKE ORDINARY LIQUIDS, CHEMICALS CANNOT BE IDENTIFIED BY APPEARANCE ALONE. A LIQUID THAT LOOKS LIKE WATER COULD ACTUALLY BE AN ACID, AN ALKALI OR A CORROSIVE SUBSTANCE. THEREFORE, STUDENTS MUST NEVER TOUCH, TASTE OR SMELL ANY CHEMICAL DIRECTLY.

WE FOLLOW STRICT SAFETY PROTOCOLS, AND ACCESS TO THE CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS CAREFULLY SUPERVISED. THIS IS ESPECIALLY IMPORTANT BECAUSE YOUNG STUDENTS CAN SOMETIMES BE CURIOUS AND IMPULSIVE. WE HAVE EVEN EXPERIENCED AN INCIDENT IN THE PAST WHERE A STUDENT ACCIDENTALLY DROPPED ACID, WHICH REINFORCED THE IMPORTANCE OF MAINTAINING STRICT LABORATORY DISCIPLINE.

WE ARE FORTUNATE TO HAVE MR. GLENN, CHEMISTRY LABORATORY COORDINATOR WHO ASSISTS US IN PREPARING THE REQUIRED SOLUTIONS, PROCURING REQUIRED CHEMICALS AND MAINTAINING OUR LAB IN UP TO DATE CONDITIONS . HIS SUPPORT IS EXTREMELY VALUABLE IN ENSURING THAT EXPERIMENTS ARE CONDUCTED SMOOTHLY. HE HAS CONTRIBUTED IMMENSELY IN SETTING UP CHEMISTRY LAB IN FAPS.

DO YOU THINK STUDENTS SHOULD BE TAKEN TO THE LABORATORY MORE OFTEN?

ABSOLUTELY! CHEMISTRY CAN SOMETIMES SEEM LIKE AN ABSTRACT SUBJECT BECAUSE STUDENTS LEARN ABOUT REACTIONS, CHEMICAL EQUATIONS AND CONCEPTS PRIMARILY THROUGH TEXTBOOKS.

TAKING STUDENTS TO THE **LABORATORY ALLOWS THEM TO EXPERIENCE CHEMISTRY PRACTICALLY**. THEY CAN OBSERVE COLOUR CHANGES, THE FORMATION OF PRECIPITATES (PPT), EVOLUTION OF GASES AND OTHER VISIBLE CHANGES DURING CHEMICAL REACTIONS.

FOR INSTANCE, WHEN STUDENTS ACTUALLY SEE A REACTION TAKING PLACE, THEY ARE MORE LIKELY TO UNDERSTAND AND REMEMBER THE CONCEPT.

HOWEVER, PRACTICAL IMPLEMENTATION CAN SOMETIMES BE CHALLENGING, PARTICULARLY WITH YOUNGER STUDENTS, AS MAINTAINING DISCIPLINE AND ENSURING EVERYONE'S SAFETY IS ESSENTIAL. THEREFORE, WE OFTEN PREFER CONDUCTING DEMONSTRATIONS IN THE CLASSROOM UNDER CONTROLLED CONDITIONS.

NEVERTHELESS, AS THE HEAD OF THE CHEMISTRY DEPARTMENT, I STRONGLY BELIEVE THAT HANDS-ON LABORATORY EXPERIENCE IS EXTREMELY VALUABLE AND SHOULD BE AN INTEGRAL PART OF SCIENCE EDUCATION...

DOES PRACTICAL EXPOSURE TO SCIENCE INFLUENCE A STUDENT'S CHOICE OF STREAM?

I BELIEVE THAT CHOOSING A STREAM IS LARGELY A MATTER OF INDIVIDUAL INTEREST, APTITUDE AND INSTINCT. IN MY EXPERIENCE, APPROXIMATELY 7–8 OUT OF EVERY 10 STUDENTS ARE QUITE CLEAR ABOUT THEIR PREFERRED STREAM AND CAREER INTERESTS.

THERE IS ALSO A COMMON MISCONCEPTION THAT SCIENCE IS SUPERIOR TO COMMERCE OR HUMANITIES. I STRONGLY DISAGREE WITH THIS BELIEF. **EVERY STREAM HAS ITS OWN VALUE, OPPORTUNITIES AND CAREER POSSIBILITIES.**

LABORATORY EXPOSURE CAN CERTAINLY STIMULATE CURIOSITY AND DEVELOP AN INTEREST IN SCIENCE. HOWEVER, A STUDENT'S DECISION TO CHOOSE A PARTICULAR STREAM SHOULD NOT BE BASED SOLELY ON LABORATORY EXPERIENCES. THEIR INTERESTS, ABILITIES, ASPIRATIONS AND LONG-TERM GOALS SHOULD ALSO BE

HOW CAN THE LABS BE MADE BETTER IN YOUR OPINION?

ALTHOUGH OUR CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS REASONABLY WELL-EQUIPPED, THERE IS ALWAYS SCOPE FOR IMPROVEMENT.

SAFETY IN A CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS NON-NEGOTIABLE. EVERY STUDENT MUST UNDERSTAND AND FOLLOW THESE RULES BEFORE ENTERING THE LABORATORY.

THE THREE MOST IMPORTANT REQUIREMENTS ARE:

1. WEAR A WHITE LABORATORY COAT: THIS IS COMPULSORY. IT PROTECTS CLOTHING AND PROVIDES A BASIC LAYER OF PROTECTION AGAINST ACCIDENTAL CHEMICAL SPLASHES.
2. WEAR PROTECTIVE GLOVES: ALWAYS USE APPROPRIATE CHEMICAL-RESISTANT GLOVES WHEN HANDLING CHEMICALS.
3. PROTECT YOUR EYES: SAFETY GOGGLES MUST BE WORN DURING EXPERIMENTS TO PREVENT CHEMICAL SPLASHES OR PARTICLES FROM ENTERING THE EYE

A CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS A PLACE TO EXPLORE, EXPERIMENT AND DISCOVER, BUT SAFETY MUST ALWAYS COME BEFORE CURIOSITY.

A GOLDEN REMINDER:

BE ALERT. BE RESPONSIBLE. BE SAFE.

A CHEMISTRY LABORATORY IS A PLACE TO EXPLORE, EXPERIMENT AND DISCOVER, BUT SAFETY MUST ALWAYS COME BEFORE CURIOSITY.

REMEMBER: NO EXPERIMENT IS WORTH RISKING YOUR SAFETY!

– MRS DIMPLE BAFNA (HOD CHEMISTRY)

Riddles and Quotes

1.“Who Am I” of the Week:

The more I lie, the more people trust me. Who am I?

2.You Be The Detective:

A valuable painting is stored in a vault. After a visit from someone with access, its owner finds a plain black canvas in its place. The original canvas has never left the vault. How could the picture have disappeared?

(ANSWERS ON THE LAST PAGE)

THE ONLY MYSTERY IN LIFE IS WHY THE KAMIKAZE PILOTS WORE HELMETS.

-AL MCGUIRE

COMICS

Calvin and Hobbes



Garfield



PEANUTS



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Answers to Riddles:

“Who Am I”: [A politician.]

“You Be The Detective”: [It was painted over. A layer of black paint covered the picture. The original was still there, hidden underneath.]

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